



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

CREDIT TRANSFER, EXEMPTION AND PRIOR LEARNING ASSESSMENT RECOGNITION POLICY AND PROCEDURES

Title: NPCJ Credit Transfer, Exemption and Prior Learning Assessment Recognition Policy and Standard Operating Procedures	Number: JCF/NPCJ/PL/SFs/0016/2025
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1. Introduction

- 1.1. Credit Transfer, Exemption, and Prior Learning Assessment Recognition (CTPLAR) are critical components of academic governance. They give participants a transparent understanding of the requirements and procedures for transferring credits, obtaining exemptions, and recognizing prior learning experiences. This policy outlines the framework for assessing prior learning and determining the transferability of credits while ensuring fairness, equity, and adherence to academic standards.

2. Purpose

- 2.1. The purpose of this policy is to:
 - 2.1.1. Provide a structured process for recognizing and evaluating prior learning.
 - 2.1.2. Ensure the fair and equitable treatment of participants seeking credit transfers or exemptions.
 - 2.1.3. Maintain the academic integrity and standards of the institution.

3. Scope

- 3.1. This policy applies to all participants of the National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ) seeking credit transfers, exemptions, or recognition of prior learning for academic programmes offered by the institution. It encompasses traditional academic credits, micro-credential courses, and experiential learning.

4. Abbreviations and Acronyms

- 4.1. CTPLAR: Credit Transfer, Exemption, and Prior Learning Assessment Recognition
- 4.2. NPCJ: National Police College of Jamaica
- 4.3. PLA: Prior Learning Assessment

5. Definitions

- 5.1. **Credit Transfer** grants credit for coursework completed at another recognized institution.
- 5.2. **Exemption** waives specific course requirements based on the assessment of prior learning or experience.
- 5.3. **Prior Learning Assessment (PLA)** evaluates learning acquired outside traditional academic environments, such as professional experience or training.
- 5.4. **Micro-credentials** are short, specialized courses that provide focused learning in a specific subject area.
- 5.5. **Law Enforcement** describes any organization, agency and employee responsible for enforcing laws, maintaining public order, and managing public safety.

6. Responsibilities

- 6.1. **Participants:**
 - 6.1.1. Submit accurate and complete documentation to support credit transfer, exemption, or PLA applications.
 - 6.1.2. Adhere to established timelines for submissions and appeals.

6.2. Programme Coordinators:

- 6.2.1. Guide participants through the CTPLAR process.
- 6.2.2. Ensure participants are informed about procedures, deadlines, and requirements.

6.3. Heads of Faculty

- 6.3.1. Evaluate credit transfer and exemption applications based on established criteria.
- 6.3.2. Communicate decisions to participants within specified timeframes.

6.4. Dean, Academic Studies has the responsibilities to:

- 6.4.1. Assess PLA applications and determine appropriate evaluation methods.
- 6.4.2. Notify the head of faculty and the respective participant of outcomes within the prescribed timeframe.
- 6.4.3. Share information regarding credit transfer and exemption assessment with the Student Registrar

6.5. CTEPLAR Committee within the Academic Board:

- 6.5.1. Review and approve policies and procedures related to credit transfer, exemption, and PLA decisions.
- 6.5.2. Ensure consistent application of policies across departments.

6.6. Student Registrar

- 6.6.1. Make adjustments to students' transcripts regarding credit transfer and exemptions.

7. Standard Operating Procedures

7.1. Prior Learning Assessment (PLA)

- 7.1.1. Participants must meet with their programme coordinator to discuss their credit transfer, exemption, and prior learning assessment options.
- 7.1.2. The programme coordinator will inform the participant about the process and the requirements for making an application.
- 7.1.3. The participant must complete and submit all documentation for the application. These requirements include:
 - 7.1.3.1. An application letter stating the course or courses for which credit transfer and exception are being requested.
 - 7.1.3.2. Transcript(s) from previous learning environments
 - 7.1.3.3. A completed portfolio which includes a resume/curriculum vitae, certified copies of qualifications and course-specific course outlines/qualification plans.
- 7.1.4. The Dean, Academic Studies, will evaluate the application and determine the appropriate PLA method.
- 7.1.5. The participant will receive the results of the PLA assessment within 30 business days.

7.2. Credit Transfer

- 7.2.1. A prior learning assessment of the participant's transcript and portfolio will be conducted to determine the transferability of credits according to the following criteria:
 - 7.2.1.1. Credits to be transferred should be awarded from a registered institution
 - 7.2.1.2. Coursework (not remedial or developmental) represents tertiary-level and is completed with an alphabet grade of 'C' or better
 - 7.2.1.3. Comparability of course-content learning outcomes
 - 7.2.1.4. Applicability towards meeting the certification requirements of the current course or programme.

7.3. Appeals Process

- 7.3.1. If a participant disagrees with the decision regarding credit transfer or PLA assessment, they may appeal in writing to the Academic Board within 10 business days of receiving the credit transfer response.
- 7.3.2. The Academic Board will review the appeal and make a decision within 30 business days.

7.4. Micro-credentials

- 7.4.1. Micro-credential courses are a form of continuing education that allows participants to gain specialized knowledge and skills in a particular area of study. These courses typically offer a shorter duration than traditional courses and can be completed online or in person. To ensure that participants can use the credits earned from micro-credential courses, it is essential to have a clear and well-defined procedure for the transfer of credits.

7.5. Assessment of Micro-credential Courses for Transfer

- 7.5.1. The department/faculty offering the course in which the micro-credential course credit is applied must evaluate the content and determine if it meets the learning outcomes of the corresponding course.
- 7.5.2. If the micro-credential course meets the learning outcomes of the corresponding course, the academic department will award credit to the participant.

7.6. Limitations on Course Credits

- 7.6.1. Generally, students are not allowed to transfer or be exempted from no more than 15 credits for any programme offered at the college.
- 7.6.2. Participants can only transfer or be exempted from credits of courses that were delivered no more than five years before the credit transfer and exemption request.
- 7.6.3. However, micro-credential credits that are technical or vocational are only transferable if completed at the NPCJ or other law enforcement institutions. Where the micro-credentials are academic, they must be accredited.
- 7.6.4. The department/faculty offering the corresponding course will only grant participants a maximum of 3 micro-credential courses per programme.
- 7.6.5. The department/faculty may limit the number of credits that can be transferred from micro-credential courses to ensure that the overall academic requirements of the degree programme are met.

7.7. Notification to Participants

- 7.7.1. The course outlines will indicate to participants the number of credits awarded for the micro-credential course.
- 7.7.2. The department/faculty offering the course where the micro-credential course credit is applied will notify the participant of any additional requirements or limitations on using the micro-credential course credits.

8. Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

- 8.1. JCF Training Policy and SOP
- 8.2. NPCJ Course and Programme Delivery and Quality Control Mechanism Policy and SOP
- 8.3. NPCJ Quality Assessment Policy and Procedures
- 8.4. NPCJ Policy on Academic Integrity
- 8.5. NPCJ Student Handbook and Faculty Prospectus
- 8.6. Academic Board TOR

9. Review of Policy

- 9.1. This policy shall be reviewed every three years to remain relevant and effective. Any necessary amendments to the policy shall be made following the College's policies and procedures.